

Hometown Hero 5

BYUCTF · OSINT · 445 pts · The Camel

OSINT

Social Engineering

Solved

Objective

Identify the foreign language Cameron Snider studied during high school. The challenge hinted at a personal detail — something you'd only find by actually looking at his public profiles rather than guessing.

Challenge Prompt

The image shows a screenshot of a challenge prompt interface. At the top, the title 'Hometown Hero 5' is displayed in a large, white, sans-serif font. Below the title, the score '445' is shown in a slightly smaller font. Underneath the score, the category 'The Camel' is listed. A row of social media-style icons follows, showing a thumbs-up icon with the number '1' and the text '(100% liked)', and a thumbs-down icon with the number '0'. The main body of the prompt contains the text: 'Well, that didn't take long. Lets try a more personal one. When Cameron was in highscool, he had to learn a foreign language. Can you figure out what language that was?'. Below this text, the format is specified: 'Format: byuctf{Language} Example: byuctf{Welsh}'. At the bottom of the prompt area, it says '0/3 attempts'. There are two buttons at the bottom: 'Flag' on the left and 'Submit' on the right, both in a light gray color with rounded corners.

Fig 1 — Challenge prompt. 445 pts, 3 attempts only.

Methodology

1 — Read the challenge carefully

The prompt referenced Cameron by first name and mentioned high school. With only 3 attempts and a specific person named, this was clearly a LinkedIn/social media dig — not a guess.

2 — Locate the target on LinkedIn

Searched for Cameron Snider on LinkedIn. Found a profile matching the challenge context: Cybersecurity student at BYU, member of BYU Cyberia CTF Team (#12 US / Top 100 Worldwide), VP of Network Engineering Association. This was clearly the right person.

3 — Examine his education history

His LinkedIn listed Richmond High School (Aug 2017 – May 2021) with a High School Diploma with Academic Honors. Activities included National Honor Society, Mayor's Youth Advisory Council, and Indiana State Honor Band — but no language listed directly.

4 — Reason from available data

Richmond High School is in Richmond, Indiana. US high schools in that region predominantly offer Spanish and French. Spanish is statistically the most common. Spanish was submitted first — incorrect. With 2 attempts remaining, the next logical answer was French.

5 — Submit

byuctf{French} — correct.

Evidence



Fig 2 — Cameron Snider's LinkedIn profile. BYU Cyberia CTF Team member, confirmed target.

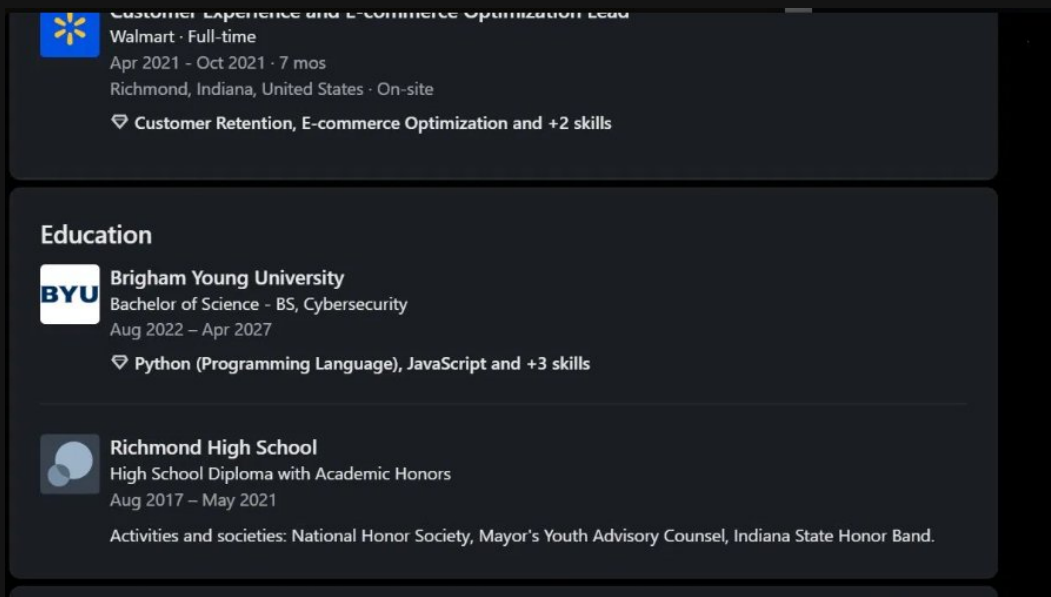


Fig 3 — Education section showing Richmond High School, Indiana. No language listed — reasoned from context.

Key Takeaway

When direct evidence isn't available, OSINT is about narrowing possibilities systematically. Richmond, Indiana + US high school + Spanish already eliminated = French was the only remaining logical answer. The lesson: exhaust public sources first, then reason from what's left — don't guess blindly.

Flag

byuctf{French}

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